

Damian Ortega

IT Engineer

Email: damian.ortega@gmail.com | Phone: 786-414-0117

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/damian-ortega>

Work Experience

Zumba, LLC

DevOps Engineer, 2023-Present

- Operate as part of a small, agile DevOps team managing infrastructure supporting Zumba's global website and mobile applications.
- Orchestrate infrastructure management and configuration with SaltStack, improving environment consistency and reducing manual intervention.
- Managed end-to-end deployment and operation of LAMP stacks, including Linux server setup, Apache/Nginx configuration, MySQL database administration, and PHP application deployment, optimizing system reliability and performance.
- Enhanced CI/CD with GitHub Actions, replacing legacy systems and Azure resources, improving build reliability, speeding deployments, and reducing infrastructure costs.
- Integrated Datadog for system observability and on-call management, implementing dashboards, metrics, and alerts that reduced incident detection time and replaced PagerDuty, eliminating the additional monthly licensing costs.
- Independently managed incident response and post-incident analysis, leading root-cause investigations and driving reliability improvements across production systems.
- Proactively identified and remediated AWS security issues and misconfigurations, strengthening the environment's overall security posture.
- Identified and implemented AWS cost optimizations, including S3 and CloudFront cleanup, instance right-sizing, and decommissioning unused resources.
- Collaborated on efforts to migrate infrastructure toward containerized and immutable deployments, improving scalability and maintainability as well as reducing infrastructure costs by ~15%.
- Authored and maintained internal documentation on DevOps practices and user procedures to streamline operations and accelerate onboarding.

Professional Summary

Highly driven and results oriented Information Technology Engineer with 15 years of technical experience. Adept at building scalable infrastructure, improving CI/CD pipelines, and driving operational efficiency across cloud and on-prem environments.

Technical Skills

Scripting
Python, Bash, PowerShell

Virtualization
VMWare, AWS

Automation
Jenkins, Bitbucket, Octopus,
Cloudformation, Nexus, Terraform,
SonarQube, Fastlane, SaltStack, IaC

Orchestration
SaltStack, Kamal, Docker, Kubernetes

Secrets Management
AWS Secrets Manager, etcd, Vault, 1
Password, SaltStack Pillars

Linux
CentOS, RHEL, Ubuntu, UNIX

Windows Server
2008-2019

Storage
IBM SAN/NAS, Dell EMC, NetApp,
Promise Storage Solutions, HP

Ticketing
Jira, ServiceNow

Damian Ortega

IT Engineer

786-414-0117

damian.ortega@gmail.com

Work Experience, Continued

ChenMed, LLC

Senior Systems Administrator, 2021-2023

Systems Administrator, 2019-2021

- Implemented a massive overhaul of the existing patching process by implementing automations to backup and refresh our internal yum repo, creation of golden AMIs, redeployment of ephemeral infrastructure as code environment and patching of all standalone systems reducing the amount of time it took to patch from 2 weeks to 2 days and free up admins to focus on other tasks.
- Moved existing Infrastructure as Code environment into Kubernetes. Implemented init containers for static applications. Implemented master helm charts for init containers and new application types. Built new Docker containers for net new application types.
- Heavy focus on creating and implementing automation tasks with the use of Jenkins, AWS Lambda, Python, and Powershell, and bash scripts reducing the need for manual intervention and human error.
- Identify and analyze issues and areas where automated responses or jobs can be implemented to improve day to day operations with minimal impact to the end-user experience.
- Developed CI/CD pipelines for multiple languages (Java, Node.js, .NET, Python, iOS, Android), increasing deployment frequency while reducing tooling overhead.
- Transformed legacy applications running Java, PHP, and .NET to a modern Infrastructure as Code design using CloudFormation templates.
- Built out pipelines for new application architectures and built out utilizing existing CI/CD environment maintaining consistency and re-usability of existing pipeline jobs.
- Reduced costs of a multi-million dollar AWS spending bill by implementing and fine tuning an automation task to automatically right-size the standalone environment based on AWS recommendations.
- Implement and maintain monitoring solutions at the server and application level in order to increase visibility into day-to-day operations and issues utilizing Solarwinds, Solarwinds DPA, NewRelic and GrayLog

Damian Ortega

IT Engineer

786-414-0117

damian.ortega@gmail.com

Work Experience, Continued

- Managed blue/green deployments of Infrastructure as Code systems using in house tools
- Helped bring the company to attain a NIST 3.0 certification from a 1.8 in the span of 3 months.
- Generating well defined and documented standard processes for common tasks and automated jobs

Systems Administrator

University of Miami

July 2014 - December 2019

Junior level system administrator for the Storage and Unix team for the university. Responsible for setup, maintenance, and break/fix for key structural systems. Knowledge with AIX 6.1/7.1, some RedHat and Suse Linux. Heavy role in storage systems from Dell, EMC, IBM, and others.

- Developed and implemented strategies for new and existing SAN enterprise storage as well as re-purposing aging but functional systems.
- Maintained SAN systems including Dell Compellent, Equallogic, MD Powervault systems, EMC Isilon and Vmax/AllFlash, Promise, IBM DS Series, IBM Storwize, NetApp, HP msa2312, P2000s, and EVA 8K.
- Configure, maintain, and upgrade Cisco MDS Switches and Fabric Manager
- IBM HMC – HMC Configure, manage and upgrade. LPAR Deployment
- Configure, maintain, and upgrade AIX 7.1/7.2 systems with and without HACMP (PowerHA)

Desktop Support Technician

University of Miami

August 2009 - July 2014

- Assisted end users with common issues such as trouble with email, passwords, and Office applications.
- Configured network shares on NetApp appliance, and later Windows DFS
- Managed network share quotas and permissions
- Created and managed users and groups through Active Directory services
- Participated in migration from on-prem Outlook to Office 365 environment
- Managed ticketing queue through ServiceNow